

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The Fed's Powell** told Congress that the sound state of the U.S. economy permits the central bank to take its time to decide whether and when to cut interest rates. **A2**
- ◆ **The S&P 500** rose less than 0.1% in a session that delivered a 0.3% gain for the Dow industrials and a loss of 0.4% for the Nasdaq. **B11**
- ◆ **Kering's revenue** fell by less than analysts expected in the fourth quarter as the Gucci owner seeks to reinvigorate a turnaround plan for its core brand. **B1**
- ◆ **New York-based insurer** Travelers said it expects pre-tax catastrophe losses of \$1.7 billion from the Southern California wildfires. **B1**
- ◆ **Novartis agreed** to acquire Blackstone Life Sciences' Anthos Therapeutics for up to \$3.08 billion to boost its cardiovascular-drug pipeline. **B2**
- ◆ **BP said it would alter** its strategy days after it was reported that Elliott had taken a stake in the oil company with plans to improve shareholder returns. **B3**
- ◆ **SMIC, China's largest** chip maker, reported lower profit during the traditional off-peak season but said it expects continued revenue growth in the current quarter. **B4**
- ◆ **Shopify's profit** doubled in the fourth quarter after revenue rose by nearly a third, boosted by strong sales during the holidays and deeper integration with more online merchants. **B4**
- ◆ **Marriott International's** share price fell 4.7% after the hotel operator said profit declined in the fourth quarter and offered guidance that disappointed investors. **B2**

World-Wide

- ◆ **King Abdullah II**, the first Arab leader to visit the White House since Trump called for taking control of Gaza and relocating its two million residents, dodged a public confrontation but avoided endorsing the president's plan. **A1**
- ◆ **American high-school teacher** Marc Fogel, who had been detained in Russia since 2021, arrived in the U.S. after being freed in a deal brokered by Trump's special envoy. **A1**
- ◆ **Elon Musk defended** his cost-cutting plans as a campaign to curb federal spending, amid opposition from Democrats and legal challenges that have stalled some of his efforts. **A4**
- ◆ **Vice President Vance** said the U.S. intended to dominate the artificial-intelligence revolution and counseled leaders at a summit to fall in with the U.S. light-touch approach to tech regulation. **A7**
- ◆ **Israeli Prime Minister** Benjamin Netanyahu demanded that Hamas release Israeli hostages by noon on Saturday or face a return to war as reports about the condition of those set free last week heightened concern for the remaining captives. **A8**
- ◆ **Podcast host Steve Bannon** pleaded guilty in a New York state criminal case related to a fundraising scheme that defrauded donors to a border-wall nonprofit. **A3**
- ◆ **A judge ordered** the Trump administration to restore government health websites and data sets that were modified or taken down in an effort to scrub references to what the White House called gender ideology. **A3**

CONTENTS		Opinion.....	A15-17
Arts in Review...	A13	Personal Journal	A11-12
Business & Finance	B2	Property Report...	B6
Business News...	B3,5	Sports.....	A14
Crossword.....	A14	Technology.....	B4
Heard on Street...	B12	U.S. News.....	A2-6
Markets.....	B11	World News.....	A7-8



© 2025 Dow Jones & Company, Inc.
All Rights Reserved



ALISON ROBERT/AP/GETTY IMAGES

High school teacher Marc Fogel, wearing an American flag around his neck, was at the White House on Tuesday after flying back to the U.S. from Russia to end a 1,277-day ordeal.

Russians Free American Left Out of Prisoner Swap

By DREW HINSHAW
AND JOE PARKINSON

Just minutes before President Trump escaped an assassin's bullet at a campaign rally in Butler, Pa., he held a brief backstage meeting with a 95-year-old local woman whose son, Marc Fogel, had spent three years in a Russian jail. Linking arms with Trump, Malphine Fogel recounted her son's ordeal, how she was struggling to get the Biden administration to prioritize his case and her fears for his health. Flashing a thumbs-up before a camera, Trump prom-

ised to "get him out," then invited her onto the VIP section of the stage to watch him speak. She was only feet away from the rostrum when shots rang out, with a single bullet grazing Trump's ear. The candidate was tackled and a congressman shielded Fogel from incoming fire. On Tuesday, the high school history teacher who ultimately spent 1,277 days in Russian custody flew back to the U.S. with President Trump's special envoy Steve Witkoff. He landed at night and was personally greeted by Trump at the White House.

"I feel like the luckiest man on Earth right now," said Fogel, an American flag draped around his neck. "I will forever be indebted to President Trump, to Steve over there." "It's great to have you back," Trump replied. Fogel's arrest—for flying into Moscow with medically prescribed marijuana—became a fraught test of Washington's efforts to determine which Americans jailed overseas were worthy of rescue. The 63-year-old, who worked at the elite Anglo-American School in Moscow, was one in

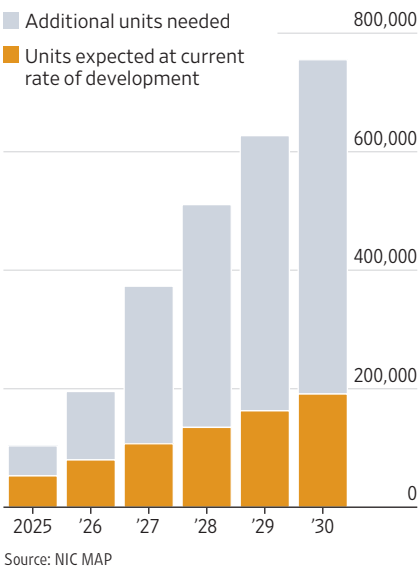
Please turn to page A6

Senior Housing Gets Lift

Projected cumulative number of senior housing units to be developed by 2030

■ Additional units needed
■ Units expected at current rate of development

The oldest baby boomers turn 80 in less than a year, a change that is expected to revive the senior housing market, which has been one of the biggest disappointments for commercial-real-estate investors. The sector is expected to move from its former glut to a shortage in the next five years. **B1**



Musk's Bid to Control OpenAI Steps Up Pressure on Altman

By TOM DOTAN
AND BERBER JIN

Elon Musk's offer for the assets of OpenAI could end up costing Sam Altman, whether he takes it or not. For months, the OpenAI chief executive has been working with investors to determine how to fairly compensate the nonprofit that controls the company as part of a plan to spin it out and make the ChatGPT developer a for-profit venture. Musk's \$97.4 billion offer, with the backing of a consor-

tium of investors, could force OpenAI's board to reassess how it is valuing the nonprofit, which the board said will be fairly compensated in the transaction and own a stake in the for-profit. The higher the valuation of the nonprofit, the bigger its stake would likely be in the for-profit OpenAI following a conversion. At the same time, OpenAI is negotiating how much equity Microsoft, its biggest investor, should get in the for-profit company, along with other backers and employees. It is

also seeking to raise up to \$40 billion of new capital. Investors in that round will likely expect equity when OpenAI becomes a for-profit as well. Satisfying all those parties was already complicated. If Musk's gambit increases the equity awarded to the nonprofit, it will be even more difficult. In addition to the negotiations with investors, OpenAI must get approval for its conversion from attorneys general in California, where it is based, and Delaware, where it is incorporated. Please turn to page A2

On India's Streets, Elites Yield to No One

Lawyers, journalists slap stickers on their cars for special treatment

By SHAN LI AND AAKASH HASSAN

NEW DELHI—When Amrita Mishra passed the bar exam, she rushed out to pick up one of the biggest perks of being a lawyer in India: an "Advocate" sticker to slap on the window of her car. The decal, which includes a symbol of a white collar that lawyers wear in the country's top courts, comes with superpowers, said Mishra. It keeps the traffic police off her back

and scares male drivers who think women should concede right of way on the road. "They look startled and back off," she said. Driving in New Delhi can be chaotic, but adding to the madness is an unusual caste system that gives unofficial preference to some less-than-essential workers. Lawyers, government officials, journalists and even retired military officers are among a set of professionals who adorn their

private vehicles with decals to publicize their occupations and the special status they say it confers. Not surprisingly, the practice is controversial. There are generally no laws that give preference to drivers with certain professions, outside of a few exceptions such as doctors, and some states have banned the use of stickers in private vehicles. But enforcement has been spotty. Please turn to page A10

Jordan's King Dodges Trump On Gaza Plans

Abdullah sidesteps confrontation but says he still opposes moving Palestinians

By MICHAEL R. GORDON
AND OMAR ABDEL-BAQUI

WASHINGTON—The first Arab leader to come to the White House since President Trump called for taking control of Gaza and relocating its two million residents dodged a public confrontation but avoided endorsing Trump's improbable plan. With Jordan's King Abdullah II next to him in the Oval Office, Trump vowed once again to "take" Gaza, prompting Abdullah to shift uncomfortably in his chair and to emphasize that Arab governments would counter with their own plan for postwar Gaza this month. "I have to look into the best interests of my country," Ab-

dullah said. "Let's wait until the Egyptians" present their ideas. As he sought to mollify Trump, the Jordanian monarch said his country would accept 2,000 sick children from Gaza, an announcement Trump applauded. But the president went on to reiterate his idea that Gaza would be turned into an oceanfront vacation destination, with hotels and housing for people from across the Middle East. Trump promised that the U.S. would "cherish" Gaza. But he also bluntly reiterated that the U.S. would take over the war-shattered strip. "We are going to take it." Asked what authority he would invoke, he said, "United States authority." Egypt said on Sunday it would host a summit of Arab leaders. Please turn to page A8

- ◆ **Netanyahu sets deadline** to free hostages..... **A8**
- ◆ **Hostage accounts raise alarm** about survival chances... **A8**

President's Policies Sow Uncertainty In U.S. Economy

It usually takes years for a president to leave his mark on the economy. Donald Trump has done it in just a few weeks. His plan to raise tariffs on Canada, Mexico and China has rattled markets and

the end goal seems to be an economy with a smaller role for imports, immigrants and the federal government and a bigger one for private investment. But the execution has generated intense uncertainty—among business owners, workers and trade partners—that could damp growth, at least temporarily. While Trump's election was fueled in part by voter concerns about inflation and standards of living, he nonetheless inherited a solid economy. Gross domestic product was up 2.5% from a year earlier in the fourth quarter, and Friday's employment report from the Labor Department showed that the economy added 143,000 jobs. Please turn to page A10

- ◆ **Powell says Fed can take** its time on rate cuts..... **A2**
- ◆ **Musk defends job cuts, calls** workers 'unelected'..... **A4**

INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Which drink has more alcohol? Take a quiz to see how much you're imbibing. **A11**



SPORTS
The unorthodox bet that made the Philadelphia Eagles champions. **A14**